

3.2 Assessment information

- This unit assesses speaking skills.
- First assessment: January 2018.
- The assessment is 11-13 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 40 marks and marked holistically, though some marks are allocated specifically to the debate.
- The assessment consists of a debate between the teacher/examiner and the student on an issue chosen by the student, followed by a discussion of at least two further issues chosen by the teacher/examiner.
- Pearson will **not** provide any assessment cards for this unit.
- The presentation is on **any** chosen issue by the student.
- The unit will contribute 15% towards the overall weighting for the IAL qualification.
- Assessments will be conducted by teachers/examiners in one of two prescribed assessment windows; either in November/December or in April/May in any single year. Dates for the assessment period will be confirmed at the start of each academic year. The assessment period will not always be continuous or be the same period each year, for example it will need to accommodate the Easter break, which may change from year to year. Please note that the oral examinations must be undertaken on one day only unless your centre has a large cohort, in which case it is possible to undertake them on consecutive days. A typical maximum would be 15 students per teacher per day.
- Students must complete an *Oral chosen issue form (OR3)* (which can be found in *Appendix 7: Oral assessment forms*) no more than three weeks in advance of the assessment, on which they must write a brief statement in Spanish, indicating their stance on their chosen issue. A copy of this form must be given to the teacher/examiner before the assessment. Students can take a copy of this form into the examination and may refer to this at any point during the assessment. The electronically completed *Oral chosen issue form (OR3)* must be sent with the recording to Pearson. Scanned forms will not be accepted for submission. Electronically completed forms must be sent as per guidance in the Administrative support guide. The sound files must be submitted

electronically to Pearson via a Secure file transfer. Sound files sent to the Examiner on a USB or a CD through the post will not be accepted. Please refer to the *Administrative Support Guide: Conducting oral examinations* for further details.

- Complete, unedited recordings of all assessments must be submitted to Pearson for marking. Please see the *Administrative support guide* for more information.
- All assessments will be marked against assessment criteria that can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel International A Level in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* documents and in this specification.
- Students are only permitted to complete this assessment once per session.
- Students must sign the Student speaking authentication sheet (CAS) (which can be found in *Appendix 7: Oral assessment forms*) on completion of the assessment.
- Teacher/examiners must complete the CAS form and return it to Pearson along with the examination recordings and completed *OR3 forms*.